

Does shore power cut pollution by 90%?

A public claim, tested against connection records, EU law and research

THE CLAIM

“This initiative promises to slash 90% of air pollution in the Grand Harbour.”

Infrastructure Malta, Shore-to-Ship project page, 1 December 2023

Repeated at the EUR 33 million project's launch, 10 July 2024.

Connection records from Transport Malta, via an FOI request by Amphora Media.

VERDICT

MISLEADING

Possible per ship, not what happened.

SUPPORTED

LARGELY
SUPPORTED

NOT
SUBSTANTIATED

MISLEADING

CONTRADICTED

MAIN RESULTS

Grade B

Works when ships plug in

Research: time at berth causes most of a cruise ship's emissions in port.

2030

Voluntary until then

EU law makes plugging in compulsory only from 1 January 2030.

9%

Of berth time plugged in

67 of 373 berths connected, Jul 2024 – Jul 2025; one ship made half.

0%

Of long stays

No ship staying two to four days plugged in.

+8%

More cruise calls

385 calls in 2025, up from 357 in 2024.

FAIR TO SAY

Shore power is a sound technology and use may grow. The 90% is Infrastructure Malta's figure for ships that plug in; the 2023 page made it harbour-wide. No one has measured the harbour's air before and after.

WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT

☐ Transport Malta's connection log.

☐ The study behind the 90% figure.

☐ ERA's Senglea shipping study.

☐ Terms of the shore power deals.